

Retirement Planning Input Checklist

Everything you need to gather before building a retirement income plan. Work through it once and any plan you build starts from something solid.

Use this checklist before building your first retirement income plan or updating an existing one.

You do not need every item to be exact before you start. A first version can use reasonable estimates. The goal is to organize the main inputs so the plan can be reviewed, questioned, and improved.

1. Personal Planning Details

- ☐ Current age
- ☐ Expected retirement age
- ☐ Plan end age
- ☐ Filing status
- ☐ Country of citizenship
- ☐ Expected country of residence
- ☐ Expected state or region of residence, if relevant
- ☐ Household size
- ☐ Spouse or partner details, if planning jointly
- ☐ Dependents or family support obligations
- ☐ Major planned relocation, if any
- ☐ Expected retirement lifestyle
- ☐ Desired level of legacy or estate preservation

2. Retirement Timeline

List the major ages or dates when something changes.

- ☐ Retirement start age
- ☐ Spouse or partner retirement age
- ☐ Social Security claiming age
- ☐ Spouse or partner Social Security claiming age
- ☐ Pension start age
- ☐ Medicare start age
- ☐ ACA marketplace coverage period
- ☐ Required minimum distribution start age
- ☐ Mortgage payoff date, if relevant
- ☐ Planned home sale or relocation date
- ☐ Planned part-time work period
- ☐ Expected reduction or increase in spending

- ☐ Major one-time expenses

3. Account Balances

Separate balances by account type. Do not combine everything into one total.

- ☐ Traditional 401k balance
- ☐ Traditional IRA balance
- ☐ Roth IRA balance
- ☐ Roth 401k balance
- ☐ Cash savings
- ☐ High-yield savings or money market balance
- ☐ Taxable brokerage balance
- ☐ Estimated unrealized gains in taxable brokerage account
- ☐ Health savings account balance, if used for retirement planning
- ☐ Pension lump sum value, if applicable
- ☐ Annuity value, if applicable
- ☐ Rental property equity, if relevant
- ☐ Other assets intended to support retirement income

4. Growth and Return Assumptions

Use realistic assumptions and test conservative versions later.

- ☐ Expected annual return for traditional retirement accounts
- ☐ Expected annual return for Roth accounts
- ☐ Expected annual return for taxable brokerage accounts
- ☐ Expected cash interest rate
- ☐ Expected real estate income or appreciation, if relevant
- ☐ Inflation assumption
- ☐ Social Security COLA assumption
- ☐ Pension increase assumption
- ☐ UK State Pension / Triple Lock assumption, if relevant
- ☐ Currency exchange rate assumption, if relevant

5. Income Sources

For each income source, note the monthly amount, start age, end age if applicable, and whether it adjusts for inflation.

- ☐ Social Security
- ☐ Spouse or partner Social Security
- ☐ UK State Pension
- ☐ Employer pension

- ☐ Private pension
- ☐ Annuity income
- ☐ Rental income
- ☐ Part-time work
- ☐ Consulting or business income
- ☐ Royalties or creator income
- ☐ Dividends and interest
- ☐ Other recurring income

6. Spending Needs

Start with monthly spending in today's dollars.

Essential Spending

- ☐ Housing
- ☐ Food
- ☐ Utilities
- ☐ Insurance
- ☐ Healthcare premiums
- ☐ Prescriptions and out-of-pocket healthcare
- ☐ Transportation
- ☐ Basic taxes
- ☐ Debt payments
- ☐ Required family support
- ☐ Other non-negotiable expenses

Discretionary Spending

- ☐ Travel
- ☐ Dining out
- ☐ Hobbies
- ☐ Entertainment
- ☐ Gifts
- ☐ Home upgrades
- ☐ Vehicle replacement
- ☐ Extra family support
- ☐ Subscriptions and memberships
- ☐ Other optional spending

7. Healthcare Assumptions

Healthcare should be reviewed separately before and after Medicare.

Before Medicare

- ☐ Expected healthcare coverage type
- ☐ ACA marketplace coverage, if applicable
- ☐ Expected monthly premium
- ☐ Household size for ACA calculations
- ☐ Expected MAGI
- ☐ Desired ACA income range, if relevant
- ☐ Cost-sharing reduction eligibility, if relevant
- ☐ Expected deductible and out-of-pocket exposure
- ☐ Private insurance costs, if applicable
- ☐ International or local healthcare costs, if living abroad

Medicare Years

- ☐ Medicare start age
- ☐ Part B premium assumption
- ☐ Part D premium assumption
- ☐ Medigap or Medicare Advantage cost
- ☐ Prescription cost estimate
- ☐ Expected out-of-pocket costs
- ☐ IRMAA threshold sensitivity
- ☐ Long-term care concern or reserve

8. Tax Assumptions

Use current values when possible and verify before making major decisions.

- ☐ Filing status
- ☐ Standard deduction
- ☐ Additional deduction for age 65+, if applicable
- ☐ Federal tax bracket thresholds
- ☐ State tax assumptions, if applicable
- ☐ Social Security taxation assumption
- ☐ Capital gains assumptions
- ☐ Traditional retirement account withdrawal tax treatment
- ☐ Roth withdrawal assumptions
- ☐ Roth conversion assumptions
- ☐ Required minimum distribution assumptions
- ☐ IRMAA thresholds
- ☐ ACA/FPL values
- ☐ Foreign tax or treaty considerations, if relevant

9. Withdrawal Planning Inputs

For each phase, estimate how spending will be funded.

- ☐ Traditional IRA / 401k withdrawals
- ☐ Roth withdrawals
- ☐ Cash withdrawals
- ☐ Taxable brokerage withdrawals
- ☐ Pension income
- ☐ Social Security income
- ☐ Rental or passive income
- ☐ Part-time work
- ☐ Planned Roth conversions
- ☐ Planned one-time withdrawals
- ☐ Planned large expenses

10. Scenario Names to Save

Create separate versions instead of overwriting the baseline.

- ☐ Baseline Plan
- ☐ Improved Plan
- ☐ Conservative Plan
- ☐ Higher Spending Plan
- ☐ Lower Spending Plan
- ☐ Retire Earlier Plan
- ☐ Retire Later Plan
- ☐ Claim Social Security at 62
- ☐ Claim Social Security at Full Retirement Age
- ☐ Delay Social Security to 70
- ☐ Roth Conversion Plan
- ☐ ACA-Protected Plan
- ☐ IRMAA-Aware Plan
- ☐ Expat Plan
- ☐ Stay-in-Home-Country Plan

11. First Planning Session Checklist

- ☐ Enter personal details
- ☐ Enter account balances by type
- ☐ Enter income sources
- ☐ Enter spending needs
- ☐ Enter healthcare assumptions

- ☐ Enter tax assumptions
 - ☐ Enter baseline withdrawals
 - ☐ Review each phase
 - ☐ Check net income
 - ☐ Check real income
 - ☐ Check ending balances
 - ☐ Review Plan Health
 - ☐ Identify the weakest phase
 - ☐ Save the baseline
 - ☐ Test one change at a time
 - ☐ Save improved and conservative versions
 - ☐ Write down open questions
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Where to go next

Put these numbers to work in the AI Retirement Income Planner — it models income, taxes, Social Security, healthcare and withdrawals month by month, privately in your browser. Try the free demo at <https://airetirementincomeplanner.com/demo.html>.

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